

SchemeConnect

MVP Feature List

Benchmarked against the National Scholarship Portal (scholarships.gov.in/scholarshipEligibility) and combined user research across 5 stakeholder interviews + citizen insights report

Baseline: What the Official Government Tool Already Does

The National Scholarship Portal's Eligibility Checker lets users select state, category (SC/ST/OBC/Minority/PwD/General), and course level to surface matching schemes across 140+ central and state programs. It requires Aadhaar-based One Time Registration (OTR) to apply, tracks applications through institute → district → state verification, and disburses funds via Direct Benefit Transfer. It is available in English and Hindi only.

Conclusion: NSP is an **application and disbursal engine**, not a trust layer. It has no freshness indicators, no plain-language eligibility explanations, no fraud-verification signal, no offline/human support channel, and no regional-language coverage beyond Hindi — confirming nearly every gap identified across all four research sources.

P0 — Must-Have

Core Loop

Feature	What It Does	Why (Evidence)
Eligibility Matcher	User enters age, income, category, state, and course level to receive matching schemes (central + state)	Mirrors NSP's core function; validated 5/5 by PhD student, requested by admin
Official Source Verification	Every result links to the scheme's official government page/circular, with a verified badge	#1 rated need across all interviews; addresses NSP's lack of per-scheme sourcing clarity
Last-Updated Timestamp	Every scheme shows when it was last confirmed active	Rated 5/5 trust driver by PhD student; solves the reshared-without-dates failure mode
Plain-Language Eligibility Explainer	Shows why a user qualifies, not just pass/fail, decoding rules like OBC creamy layer and EWS renewal	Rated 4/5; addresses PhD student's and teacher's category-confusion pain point
Document Readiness Checklist	Upfront list of required documents/certificates per scheme, including any hidden steps (e.g. hard-copy mailing)	Solves the buried-requirement failure that caused a missed deadline for the PhD student

Pre-Enrollment Status Verification	Explicit active/verified check shown before a user starts the enrollment process, not discovered only after	2nd college student currently discovers expiry/ineligibility only after enrolling; repeated late-stage failure has begun actively suppressing her willingness to search at all — the most severe symptom found across all interviews
Mobile-First UI	Fully responsive, touch-first, lightweight interface	Confirmed as near-universal device across all four research sources

P1 — Should-Have

Trust & Retention

Feature	What It Does	Why (Evidence)
Hindi + Regional Language Toggle	Full UI and scheme text available in regional languages, beyond just Hindi/English as on NSP	Confirmed adoption driver by citizen report and PhD student
Application Status Tracker	Aggregated dashboard across multiple applications with simple state labels: submitted / under review / rejected	PhD student personally lost track of applications with no notification system
Progressive Profiling	Lets users browse/preview schemes anonymously before requiring income, category, or Aadhaar data	NSP requires OTR upfront; citizens are hesitant to share sensitive data early
Peer Tips / Community Notes	Short, moderated tips from past applicants shown on a given scheme	Replaces the informal “ask 10 people” behavior with something structured and trustworthy
Scam/Fraud Warning Layer	Flags known fraudulent scheme messages (e.g. fake Rs. 72,000 offers) circulating on WhatsApp/social media	Rated the single largest new barrier in the citizen research report
Proactive Push Discovery	Surfaces relevant schemes to the user directly (notifications, digest), rather than requiring the user to remember to search	UG student's only discovery channel today is passive family sharing — he has no active search habit at all, so a lookup-only tool would never reach him

P2 — Post-MVP

Scale & Differentiation

- **Physical Help-Desk Locator** — interactive map of post offices, municipal desks, and other offline verification points
- **Notification/Reminder System** — alerts for upcoming deadlines and expiring circulars, pushed to both the applicant and the intermediary (teacher/administrator)
- **Institutional Dashboard** — lets teachers/admins manage scheme communication for many students at once, reducing the manual escalation-chain burden
- **Multi-Scheme Conflict Checker** — NSP allows only one central scholarship per session; warns users before they apply to overlapping/conflicting schemes
- **Value-Based Premium Tier** — UG student gave concrete willingness-to-pay figures (Rs. 300–400/month or Rs. 500–700/year) conditional on scheme value exceeding Rs. 1–2 lakh, validating a freemium business model once core

trust features are proven

Key Differentiation: NSP is an application and disbursal engine. SchemeConnect's MVP edge is being a **trust and discovery layer in front of it** — verified, dated, explained, and multilingual — that removes the manual verification work every persona in the research is currently doing by hand.

Sources: scholarships.gov.in/scholarshipEligibility (National Scholarship Portal); Primary_Teacher_Transcript.docx, Admin.docx, PHD__Student.docx, Audio_file1.pdf, College_Student_2.pdf (stakeholder interviews); SchemeConnect_User_Insights_Report.pdf (citizen research synthesis).